

ABC CONSULTANTS LTD.

PROJECT PARTY & BUSINESS COURTESY EXPENSE POLICY

Policy Version: 1.0

Effective Date: 1-1-2026

Approved By: JL7 – Executive Leadership

Applies To: All employees incurring approved project-related celebration or business courtesy expenses

1. PURPOSE

This policy defines the principles, eligibility, limits, and approval framework for:

- Project celebration / project completion parties
- Team appreciation events
- Business courtesy expenses such as gifts, meals, and small tokens of appreciation
- Ensuring expenses are **reasonable, ethical, compliant, and auditable**

The intent is to **recognize effort, celebrate milestones, and strengthen team morale**, without excess or misuse.

2. SCOPE & APPLICABILITY

This policy applies to:

- Approved project parties, milestone celebrations, and team events
- Business courtesy gifts exchanged with clients, partners, or internal teams
- Employees at **JL3–JL7**, subject to approval matrix

Exclusions:

- Personal celebrations (birthdays, anniversaries, weddings)
- Alcohol purchases not part of an approved team event
- Cash gifts, vouchers convertible to cash, or gift cards without approval

3. DEFINITIONS

Term	Definition
Project Party	A team event to celebrate project milestones or completion
Business Courtesy Gift	A non-cash item given as professional appreciation
Claimant	Employee submitting the expense
Approver	Authorized manager approving the expense
Region	India (INR) or Non-India (USD)

4. GUIDING PRINCIPLES

All expenses must be:

- **Business-justified**
 - **Reasonable and proportional**
 - **Inclusive and respectful**
 - **Compliant with anti-bribery and ethics standards**
 - **Supported by valid invoices**
-

5. PROJECT PARTY EXPENSES

5.1 Eligible Occasions

- Project completion
 - Major milestone achievement
 - Go-live or release success
 - Client appreciation (internal team only unless approved)
-

5.2 Expense Limits – Project Parties

India (INR)

Category	Limit
Per-person spend	₹1,500
Maximum per event	₹75,000
Frequency	Max 1 per project phase

Other Regions (USD)

Category	Limit
Per-person spend	\$40
Maximum per event	\$2,000
Frequency	Max 1 per project phase

Any exception beyond limits requires **JL6 recommendation + JL7 approval**.

- Units and Departments may allocate a portion of their quarterly budgets toward Project Parties and should communicate the approved budget to employees.
- All Project Party expenses must remain within the budget assigned to the respective Unit or Department. Any expenditure exceeding the allocated amount will **not** be reimbursed.
- Employees must confirm the availability of budget with their Manager before incurring any costs related to a Project Party.
- Any exception or deviation from this Policy requires approval from the **Delivery Head / Manager at PL6 or above within BEF**, along with the **Unit Financial Controller**.

5.3 Permitted Expenses

- Meals (lunch/dinner/snacks)
- Non-alcoholic beverages
- Venue charges (if applicable)
- Basic décor related to celebration
- Team cake or refreshments

5.4 Restricted / Prohibited

- Personal alcohol purchases (unless pre-approved)
 - Luxury venues
 - Entertainment with external performers
 - Family members / non-employees
 - Personal travel or stay
-

6. BUSINESS COURTESY & GIFT POLICY

6.1 Purpose of Gifts

Gifts may be given to:

- Appreciate project teams
 - Mark project completion
 - Recognize client collaboration
 - Celebrate professional milestones
-

6.2 Permissible Gift Categories

Category	Examples
Branded items	Diaries, mugs, jackets, backpacks
Office accessories	Desk organizers, planners
Food items	Dry fruits, chocolates (sealed)
Books	Professional or leadership books
Custom mementos	Trophies, plaques

6.3 Gift Value Limits

India (INR)

Recipient	Limit per person
-----------	------------------

Internal employee	₹2,000
-------------------	--------

Client / Partner	₹3,000
------------------	--------

Other Regions (USD)

Recipient	Limit per person
-----------	------------------

Internal employee	\$50
-------------------	------

Client / Partner	\$75
------------------	------

Gifts exceeding limits require **JL7 approval**.

6.4 Prohibited Gifts

- Cash or cash-equivalent (gift cards, vouchers)
- Alcohol
- Luxury items (watches, electronics, jewelry)
- Items that may be construed as inducement or bribe

7. MEALS & TEAM OUTINGS (NON-PARTY)

Eligible Scenarios

- Extended work hours
- Client workshops
- Team planning sessions

Limits

Region	Per-person limit
--------	------------------

India	₹1,000
-------	--------

Other regions	\$30
---------------	------

8. POLICY DETAILS

- The safety and security of employees must be given utmost priority by the responsible Manager when planning any Project Party organized by **ABC Consultancy**.
 - Participation in a Project Party is entirely voluntary. No employee may be compelled to attend, and this must be clearly communicated in the Project Party invitation.
 - Informal or spontaneous team lunches and dinners may be included under the approved Project Party budget.
 - Travel undertaken solely for attending a Project Party **outside city limits** will not be eligible for reimbursement.
 - Reimbursement for Project Party expenses will be limited to:
 - Food and non-alcoholic beverages
 - Local transportation within city limits
 - Venue rental for party halls
 - Event-related arrangements such as DJs, souvenirs, and similar essentials required to conduct the party
 - All official Project Parties must comply with the following conditions without exception:
 - Venues that pose safety hazards or carry a potential risk to human life are not permitted.
 - Project Parties must not be held at locations such as picnic spots near waterfalls, beaches, rivers, or any water bodies.
 - Activities such as trekking, camping, or visits to forests or similar environments are not allowed.
 - Adventure sports of any kind—including bungee jumping, parasailing, windsurfing, and similar activities—are strictly prohibited.
 - If any of the above conditions are not met, the event will **not** be considered an official Project Party of **ABC Consultancy**. Employees participating in such activities will do so entirely at their own risk, and **no reimbursements** will be provided for those events.
-

9. APPROVAL MATRIX

Expense Type	JL3-JL4	JL5	JL6	JL7
Project party (within limits)	JL5	JL6	JL7	—
Gift (within limits)	JL5	JL6	JL7	—
Exception / over-limit	—	—	Recommend	Final

JL7 is the final approving authority for all exceptions and policy deviations.

10. CLAIM PROCESS

1. Pre-approval obtained (where required)
 2. Expense incurred as per limits
 3. Claim submitted within **15 days**
 4. Original invoice attached
 5. Approval & reimbursement via ERP
-

11. AUDIT & COMPLIANCE

- All claims subject to internal audit
 - Random checks may be conducted
 - Non-compliant expenses may be rejected or recovered
-

12. MISUSE & DISCIPLINARY ACTION

- Misrepresentation may result in disciplinary action
 - Repeated violations may lead to claim suspension
-

13. POLICY EXCEPTIONS

- Must be documented with business rationale

- Require **JL7 approval only**
-

14. POLICY REVIEW

- Reviewed annually by HR & Finance
 - Amendments approved by JL7
-

15. CONTACT

For clarifications:

Finance / HR – ABC Consultants Ltd.

◆ Optional Add-Ons (I can do quickly):

- One-page **Do's & Don'ts** infographic
- Finance-friendly **approval workflow diagram**
- Region-wise **conversion table**
- Employee-friendly **FAQ version**

Just tell me what format you need next.